Force Captain She-Ra

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/30937313.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence, Major Character Death

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Force Captain She-Ra

by Sinful_Scribe

Summary

Trigger warning: violence, language, blood, self-harm/suicide

(AU) The night Adora finds the sword that lets her turn into She-Ra, her life changed forever. While Catra was looking for Adora when she was finding the sword, she got captured by Glimmer and Bow.

Adora, now the powerful She-Ra, hunted down the people who took her best friend, but by the time she found them Catra had already discovered a new sense of freedom outside of the Horde, and didn't want to go back. "I can't go back Adora. I can let Shadow Weaver hurt me anymore!"

Convinced that the princesses had corrupted her, Adora went back to the Horde and became their ultimate weapon. After years of fighting, the war is finally over. Now the great Hordak rules over Brightmoon and the other kingdoms all thanks to his weapon, She-Ra, tearing through his enemies.

Chapter 1

Walking into the dark cafeteria, I flip on the lights. Suddenly I see all my friends wearing pointy hats and a cake on the table. "Congratulations!" they all shout.

"Oh my goodness guys! Which one of you did this?"

Kyle stepped forward and shyly raised his hand. "I uh, well I did. I mean we had to celebrate. You did finally defeat the rebellion and all!"

I gave him a big hug, everyone else joining in. I spent the rest of the night hanging out with everyone, faking smiles all night. Lonnie noticeably kept her distance from me, but I'm not sure what for.

After heading back to my room I just waited like I always do. One hour after lights out is when the main lights in the hall go out, though that hour always feels like forever. I hear a slight click and the buzzing of the lights outside stops, telling me it's time to go.

I had already changed into my more generic horde armor, although I still have to show my pin. I leave my room and walk down the hall, and then I head down the elevator like usual. Every night it's the same old thing, and for what? This is pointless. It won't change what happened.

Nothing can change what she did.

"Adora, are you okay?" I felt a hand on my shoulder, making me jump.

"Oh, sorry Ace, I was just zoned out. Thinking about Catra like usual."

"Ugh again? Why are you so obsessed with that traitor?" Ace is really nice, but they've never like Catra. I don't know why but they

have a feud with Catra that she never told me about. Ace won't tell me why either.

"Ace, she was my best friend for years. To have her go off and join the rebellion like that? It hurt me more than you'll ever realize. Throughout the whole rest of the war I had to see her and her new friends hanging out and battling together." I paused. I didn't mean to say all that, it just sort of slipped out because I'm frustrated. "I just... I miss her being my friend."

"Well hey, you can forget about her cause you have me now, and I'm pretty fun right? Yeeeaaah?" They nudged my side during that last part, and I could hear the excitement in their voice. They don't have many friends here, I'm the only one that likes them.

"Of course you're fun babe, even if you are a pain in the butt." They leaned over and gave me a peck on the lips.

"That's more like it. Now come on, let's go mess with the prisoners!" They took my by the hand and practically dragged me down the hall where we were supposed to have guard duty. We really just used that time to mess with the prisoners, especially the sparkly one.

Just before rounding the last corner Ace stopped us. "Um Adora, can you do me a favor really quick?"

"That depends on the favor. I'm not going back upstairs to get you a muffin again!" We both laughed, but Ace stopped laughing and gave me a wicked grin.

"Can you please turn into She-Ra for me? It's just- it's really hot honestly..." I could see their face turn bright red as they looked at the ground.

"She-Ra isn't a toy babe, and besides you know I'm not allowed to transform in here unless we're being attacked!" I lifted their chin to make them look at me. "I'm sorry. How about you let me make it up to you?" I gave them a kiss, but during the kiss I heard

someone clear their throat, making me jump back away from Ace. "Who's there?" I called out.

Then from behind me came that all too familiar voice. "Hey Adora." I swing around to face her, noticing she was in a different cell than normal. "I didn't think you'd be this pathetic, I'm disappointed."

I didn't want to show my anger, but I could feel my face betray me as my eyebrows furrowed. "What do you mean?"

"Seriously? You come down here and make out with your cat-girl girlfriend right in front of me? You're clearly trying to make me jealous." Her voice dripped with that sarcastic, teasing tone she always has. Grrr! She infuriates me!

"First of of all, they aren't a cat-girl, they're a cat-person! Second of all, I do not like you!" I didn't mean to yell as loud as I did, but she was definitely scared for a moment.

"You're basically dating my doppelgänger, but whatever. Lie to yourself I guess."

I put my hand on my watch and whisper, "For the honor of Grayskull." After I turn into She-Ra I touch a few buttons on the keypad and drop the forcefield that blocks her cell. Immediately I stepped through and grab and lift her by the throat. "Listen here you worthless traitor, we may have been friends once, but now we are nothing. No matter how much I miss you sometimes, that will never change what you did!"

She flashes a smirk at me and says, "Aww, you miss me?"

Without thinking I throw her into the back of the room, her back slamming into the wall and knocking her out. I turn back into myself and lock the cell again. I turn and yell down the hall to another guard, "Make sure cell 36-B doesn't get any dinner tonight!"

I feel arms wrap around me reminding me that Ace is here. "Adora I'm so so sorry, I didn't realize this was her new cell!" I could tell they were lying, I know their voice.

Honestly though, I don't care. It really helped me, because I don't miss Catra anymore.

Now I hate her.

Death Blossom

Why did this have to happen today of all days? Shadow Weaver came to visit me... well 'visit' isn't the right way to put it.

She came to torture me.

Even after everything she did to me, what Adora did after was worse. She's just replaced me and tossed me aside, literally tossed me. Every time I try to get up my back flairs with pain and I sink back down. I think it may be broken, but the pain in my heart is too distracting to tell. I need to have a doctor take a look, but whether or not they'll help me is a different question.

I am a traitor after all, or at least that's how they see it. All I was doing was helping myself. I needed to get out of this place, and away from Shadow Weaver. If Glimmer and Bow hadn't captured me that day, I don't know how different everything would be...

Would I still be with the Horde? Would I even be myself still? I'm pretty sure if I had to deal with any more shit from Shadow Weaver I would've cracked. I don't want to even think about what could've happened if I had lost control like that.

Even being in the rebellion I've had my moments. There was that time Adora and her squad attacked us in Dryl and her sword got infected. I was so scared of what She-Ra could've done to my friends that I basically dropped a giant robot on her. I think that was the day I realized she wasn't going to join me.

Once she wasn't all loopy from her infection, she went right back to attacking us. There was no more confusion but she didn't even hesitate. She had lifted Glimmer by the throat, so I scratched her face.

Every time she looks in a mirror and sees herself she's reminded of me, but in a bad way. She hates me now. She used to be my best friend, and now she hates me.

I'm trying to hold it back, but I can't help but lightly cry. I hear a forced ahem come from outside my cell. "Oh Catra. You always had to be the best, but now look at you. Such a waste of space... I'm not even sure why they keep you alive in here honestly."

"Go away Ace, I don't have anything to say to you!" My voice was thick with agony, showing them how much pain I'm in. I can't stand them seeing me in pain, thinking I'm weak.

"Oh I know you don't have anything to say to me. I wouldn't listen to a single word from traitorous scum like you anyways. I just thought I'd let you know, I'm going to propose to She-Ra soon." They had this sly smirk plastered on their face, as if it had some sort of effect on me.

"So what? Why should I care?" I don't. Why would I care?

"You know exactly why!" I genuinely didn't, and I guessed my face showed that. "Wait do you actually not know?" Ace asked me before they started laughing. "You poor child! Oh wow, thank you so much, that made my day! I've got to go tell Lonnie about this, so bye."

So what if they propose to Adora? I shouldn't care. I shouldn't, but I do... I just hate Ace so much, so the idea of them marrying Adora is just the worst.

Oh shit, the time! I look up at the clock and see that it's a few minutes past 7. I scoot my way over to the back wall of my cell, my back aching the whole way, and give it three subtle taps.

On cue, Glimmer pops up into my room, leaning against the wall far too casually. "Hey Catra."

"Sup Sparkles?" I asked just as casually as she is.

"Oh you know, just hangin out." We both looked at each other before bursting into laughter.

It's an inside joke, you guys wouldn't understand.

I leaned forward from laughing and it made my back hurt, causing me to wince. "Catra, what's wrong?" Glimmer asked me, kneeling beside me.

"Oh you know, just She-Ra slamming me into a wall."

"Oop."

"Oh don't "oop" me Glim, just take me to Perfuma so I can eat her special herb stuff to fix my back."

"I'm going to do it, because I love you and of course I will, but could you try to be nicer about it?" She has a point, but I won't admit that.

"I'm perfectly nice princess. Now off to the plant witch!"

"Catra for the last time, don't call her that!" She raised her voice, but her laughing tells me she's not serious.

I moved a little and felt my back pinch, but I just keep ignoring the pain. Keep your head focused Catra, your back is messed up, focus on that right now.

OWOWOWOW I SHOULDNT HAVE DONE THAT!!!

Jeeeeez now that I'm not ignoring my back the pain suuuucks.

poof

Suddenly in front of me stands a princess covered in flowers, and to her right is Perfuma. "Hey Misty, you look quite floral today," I said to antagonize her.

"Hey Kitty, you look quite broken today." Ouch...

"Touché." I turn to Perfuma who is really concentrated growing in her little corner. She managed to find a crack in the ground of her cell so she can grow things. "Alright! Patch me up doc!"

She turns around and reveals the scariest looking plant I've ever seen in my life. "It's called a death blossom, but it actually has healing properties," she says to me in the most innocent sounding voice I've ever heard. Somehow the innocence makes it scarier. Before I can even try to resist she just shoves it in my mouth.

Tastes like cinnamon.

Blackout

I can't help but stare at it. The cell. The entire room is empty except for a bed. Just an empty prison flooded with that sickening green glow from the energy barrier, almost feeling poisonous in hue.

She's gone again... I had her in an inescapable cage and still she leaves me. I guess we're destined to be enemies forever... Even after I told myself I hated her a part of me still missed her sleeping at the foot of my bed. I thought maybe I would be able to make up with her somehow, I even brought her an extra pillow to scratch at. I have to accept Catra and I aren't going to be friends anymore. Ever.

"Ever..." I whisper, my own voice scaring me. I can feel my eyes betray me as a tear slowly makes it's way down my face, and drips onto the floor. I keep sitting on her bed while I cry for what feels like forever... I didn't even realize I had gone in the cell, but here I am. Sitting on my ex best friend's bed in the cell she escaped from. The cell I put her in.

Of course she escaped! Who wouldn't escape?! I should've predicted this. Maybe if I hadn't put her in jail she wouldn't have

left again. No, if I hadn't put her in there I wouldn't have had her back at all!

How do I get her to stay?!

"Well certainly isn't by crying like a baby." I jump off the bed and look outside the cell at whoever spoke.

"L-lonnie hi! Hey! What's up? How's your day?" I hate myself, I'm so awkward. Gathering myself up to be less, well... be less me, I try to speak again. "Sorry for that. Do you need something?"

"Only for you to stop pretending like you belong here. You're constantly checking on Catra and-" she looks behind me "you're covering up her escape."

"I am not covering anything up, I just got here!" No I didn't...

"You fucking idiot, I followed you down here! You've been sulking like a child for an hour! You haven't even checked the other cells to see if anyone else escaped because you're so in love with that fucking traitor!"

In the blink of an eye I black out and then see my hand reach out and grab her by the back of her hair. I notice the She-Ra gauntlet on my arm... When did I even transform? Looking back at her I notice how terrified she is. "I am NOT in love with Catra! I'm with Ace, and I always will be."

She put on a smile, although she was clearly still scared. "Ace? Seriously? You got into a relationship with the only other cat-person you've met besides Catra after knowing them for A WEEK! You found someone just like her and immediately started dating them, and you somehow don't realize you're in love with-"

snap

Oh shit...

Fuck!

WHAT DID I JUST DO?!

Short chapter, sorry :(❤️

Punching Bag

They're going to kill me for this, I know it. After Perfuma helped me heal and we were all done hanging out, Glimmer took me back to my cell so we wouldn't get caught. She didn't even stay for second, so I couldn't ask her to help me. She didn't have time to see it.

Instead she just left me here with Lonnie. A cold, lifeless Lonnie. Her skin slightly greyed and her eyes staring distantly at the wall. I kneel besides her and close her eyes with a shaky hand. They're going to kill me for this.

I didn't even do it, but they won't believe that. I would never have killed Lonnie, we were friends at one point...

I struggled to rip myself away from her body, tears still silently streaming down my face. I head over to the back wall of my cell and knock again to signal Glimmer. I hear a fit of sparkles behind me as she shows up and starts whining, "Catra what do you need? I'm trying to sleep."

I turned to face her and she could see my tear-stained cheeks glisten with that all too familiar green glow. I used all the energy I had to lift my hand and point behind her. That's when she saw Lonnie. "Catra... What did you do?"

I know she doesn't know that I didn't do it, but that still hurt to hear so much. The fact that she could even think I would do this breaks my heart. I'm trying to tell her it wasn't me, but the words won't come out. All I can do is shake my head and cry even harder.

Leaning down and burying my head in my lap, I can feel Glimmer wrap her arms around me. "You didn't do it did you?" I shook my head. "Do you know who did?" I shook my head again, but I did have an idea. I know that Ace and Lonnie never got along, and

Ace hates me. I wouldn't put it past them to frame me for a murder.

I felt cold as Glimmer let go of me, and when I looked up I saw barely a glimpse of her before she disappeared again. After what felt like forever, she came back and had Mermista. Mermista stared at the body for a while before looking up to Glimmer. "Look, I know I told you I'd help you hide a body if you need, but I really don't think we can since we can't leave the cells."

"Please Misty? Just help me think of something!"

"Honestly Glim, I don't think there's anything we can do. I think the best thing is leave her body in the empty cell."

"No..." I whispered. They both turned to me. "You can't just leave her alone like that. She used to be my friend... She used to be my friend!" Glimmer kneels down beside me again, but I'm shaking with anger so she backs off. "You two should leave."

"Catra I-"

"LEAVE!" Glimmer jumped back and quickly took Mermista away, leaving me with Lonnie. "I'm so sorry Lonnie. I swear I'll avenge you, you didn't deserve this."

"If she didn't deserve this, then why did you do it?" I don't even have to look to realize that it's Ace. "Just wait till Adora hears about this. That will be the greatest thing to see. That look on her face when she realizes you're a murderer. The look that will be on your face when you realize how disgusted she is by you." They start laughing at me, their voice pounding against my ears like fists on a punching bag.

As I look up at them, I can see the crooked grin plastered on their face. They don't even care that Lonnie died, they just want to see me suffer. "Did you do this?" They looked at me, a look of genuine surprise on their face.

"Wait, you didn't do this? Oh that makes this so much better!" They started laughing again, much harder this time. "They're going to kill you for this, and you didn't even do it!" As much as I hate their laugh, I hated it even more when they stopped. "As a matter of fact, you did do it. Yeah, you definitely did. I showed up to your cell to find you killing Lonnie, so I stepped in and had to kill you."

"What?" I knew exactly what they were implying, but I didn't want to seem scared.

With an evil smirk, they whispered at me. "I'm gonna enjoy this so much."

Dancing with Mara

I can't believe I killed Lonnie! What the hell is wrong with me?! I've been losing control so much lately, or more accurately, She-Ra has been losing control.

I didn't mean to do it, I swear I didn't. Something just took over me and made me do it. She-Ra keeps fighting me, all for her stupid mission.

Well I'm the one in control, not you! I've already finished my war. My mission is done. You don't matter to me anymore. You were nothing more than a weapon, you here me?

I'm so deep in my argument with my inner princess-demon that I almost missed the mob of soldiers running by my. "Hey you, what's happening?" I shout.

"A guard reported that she and another were attacked by a prisoner and needed backup." Shit, better help them.

You gonna help this time She-Ra, or are you going to keep being a bitch?

After running through the halls and taking the stairs since there were too many for the elevator, I arrive late to the scene to find it already over.

I see a body bag, but I'm unsure who's inside. To the right of the body bag, a horrible sight that causes a hitch in my breath.

My favorite feline, bloodied and beaten, chest barely rising as they struggle for air. I kneel down beside them and they weakly take my hand. "Ace, what happened?"

They point over and I turn to see Catra, handcuffed. "She k- she killed Lonnie..."

'No she didn't.'

'Who said that?'

'Adora, you can't escape me. You can't push me away. I am a part of you. I am you.'

'She-Ra... Go away! I don't want you in my head anymore! I never asked to be you!'

'And I never asked to be a villain...'

'A villain? I'm the hero! I took down all the villains! I won the fucking war you idiot!'

'You won the war for the Horde, but you lost it for the rebellion. You chose the wrong side Adora.'

'Shut up She-Ra.'

'Say my name.'

'No.'

'Say it!'

'NO!'

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"Adora, are you okay?" Ace asks me.

Yeah I'm fine, just blacked out for a second. Wait, why can't I speak? "Yep, I'm totally good Ace." No. No!

'Get out of my body! Let me control me again!'

'This is for your own good Adora. I'm going to fix everything. I gave my life for this mission once before, and unfortunately I may have to give yours.'

'I'm going to get back in control of my my body, and when I do, I'm going to figure out how to make you leave me forever.'
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'I wish you wouldn't be so spiteful towards me. I'm working for the greater good.'

'Fuck you Mara.'

'So, you do know my name.'

'You don't deserve a name other than traitor. We can be so powerful and yet you waste it all on princesses and dancing.'

'Dancing... Yes, that might just work.'

'What?'

'You need to see the past. You need to see what's missing.'

'I'm not missing anything! What don't you understand? I'm the hero here! I'm perfect!'

'You're alone.'

'Not alone enough apparently...'

'You love her you know.'

'Ace isn't a her. For a supposed good guy I thought you'd know that one.'

'Not them. Her.'

I finally look through her eyes, or I guess my eyes, and they're pointed straight at Catra.

'I miss her, but I don't love her. She was my friend, that's all.'

'Oh really? Let's dive back into those memories then. I mean, you did mention dancing.'

'Wha- No!'

I can feel her making my face smirk.

'Full honesty, I'm going to enjoy this.

Prom Dress

~flashback~

"Aw Adora, you look so cute in that dress."

"Oh uh, thanks Scorpia. It's nothing really." I can feel my entire face burning with a blush. No one's ever called me cute or anything before.

"It's not nothing! You're smiling for the first time in as long as I've known you." She's right, I haven't been smiling much, or at all really. Ever since Catra... "Hey kid, you okay? You got that look in your eyes again."

"Yeah I'm fine." No I'm not. "Just thinking about something."

"Catra again? Adora, I don't think she's coming back, as much as you want her to. Besides, from what you've told me about her she seems like a jerk."

That made me chuckle a bit. "She is, but it's not so bad. I kind of liked the way we'd tease each other." Gods I miss her... "She used to always sleep at the foot of my bed, and whenever there was a storm she'd curl up next to me to feel safe. Now she's just parading around with the princesses... It's like she's forgotten about me." I couldn't help but let a few tears fall, but I quickly corrected myself and wiped them away.

I felt Scorpia put her claw on my shoulder. "Come on, we have a prom to go to."

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"Honestly I'm just surprised this place isn't colder considering it's made of ice." She has a point. For a giant ice palace it feels like normal room temp.
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Handing her the little bombs, I ask, "Do you remember the plan?" She gives me a reassuring nod, and I nod back. It'll be fun to teach these princesses a lesson or two.

After walking up the stairs that are surprisingly not slippery at all, we enter the doors and see the big room I've ever seen in my life. The ceiling is so tall I can't really tell where it ends, all sorts of snowflakes decorated above our heads. "Jeez, no wonder the princesses are so soft."

"You do realize that I am a princess right?" Scorpia asked me.

"Well technically I am too now, so what's your point?" She-Ra is technically a princess, however I use her as my anti-princess weapon so I don't really count it.

"Ooh you're so right! How exciting is this?! Two princesses who are a part of the horde, fighting the rebel princesses! This could totally be a book or something." I pull her shoulder to make her face me which is a lot harder than you'd think considering she's a giant scorpion lady.

"I get that you want to have some fun, but remember, we have a mission." She gives me yet another reassuring nod. I'm starting to wonder if she's really understanding or is just too nervous to tell me she's confused.

We both part ways after greeting the child-queen Frosta and start setting explosives. Everything seems to be going rather smooth for once... I don't like it. Normally something would've gone wrong by now.

I hear a laugh from behind me that is all too familiar. "Speaking of something going wrong." I turn around and see Catra standing next to Princess Glimmer. Ugh, I can't believe she has the nerve to show her face around here!

Well I guess technically this is her crowd now... gross.

I guess I spent too long staring at her because I saw her notice me and she put on a strange expression. A mix of excitement and fear, like when we used to run training sims.

She's not scared of me though right? She knows I'd never hurt her.

Well, except for the times I've fought her and her friends. I always avoid fighting her until she tries defending her friends though, so that doesn't count.

Oh gods, she's coming over here. Shit, think of something to say Adora, come on. Adora she's standing in front of you now, speak!

Say something! "Sooooo... How ya doin'?"

I hate myself...

Catra let out a small giggle and said her usual, "Hey Adora." She sounds more nervous than usual. I guess it has been a while since we've properly talked.

"I- uh hi! It's uh, it's been a while."

"Yup..."

This is so awkward.

"How's Brightmoon?"

She perked up a little bit, finally having something to say. "It's actually super cool! Too much water for me, but tons of stuff to climb on which is really fun. I prank the guards a lot. So uh, how's the Fright Zone?"

Without thinking I just blurted out, "Lonely without you."

Damn it Adora... why do you have to suck so badly?

She took a step towards me and sticks out her hand. "Wanna dance with me?" I gently took her hand, mine shaking. We

danced together for a while, mostly silent with us occasionally locking eyes and giggling. I dip her and I could swear I see a blush on her face, but I know it's in my head.

Out of nowhere she asks me, "Adora, you know I'm sorry right?"

I pulled her up and stepped away, slightly angry, but mostly hurt. "Sorry for what?"

"Adora I-"

"Sorry for leaving me? Sorry for joining the rebellion? Sorry for scarring me face when you scratched me?!"

"You were attacking my friends!"

"I WAS YOUR FRIEND!" My voice echoes through the now silent ballroom, everyone at the party staring at us. Holding back tears, I just whisper at her, "I was your best friend..."

She stepped up to me again and put her hands on my shoulders. "We can still be friends! Why don't you come with me to Brightmoon? You don't have to stay with the Horde anymore! We can be together again..."

Together... Me and Catra on the same side again. But what about everyone else? I can't betray everyone I know for one person. "No." I pull the detonator for the bombs out of my pocket. "Leave. I don't want to have to hurt you."

She slightly lowered herself into a battle stance. "Adora, you know I can't let you do this."

"Try and stop me... FOR THE HONOR OF GREYSKULL!"

~end flashback~

Who Let the Cat Out?

I can't believe Ace thought they could fight me. Like, come on. Beating them to a pulp was so satisfying, but in the end it wasn't worth it. Now they definitely think I killed Lonnie and they saw me beating Ace. They probably think I was trying to kill them too.

They moved me into a different cell this time, one that's separated from all the rest. No way for Glimmer to teleport into this one... I'm not even sure why I'm alive honestly, but I'm scared to find out why.

As if on cue, I can hear the barrier of my cell power down and someone walks in. I don't even turn to face them... They're probably here to kill me.

Many moments pass and they don't say anything which just pisses me off. I turn and scream at them, "Just do it already!" and I'm met with Adora staring at me. "I- Adora. Not you..."

"I'm not here to kill you Catra. I'm getting you out of here." Time seemed to freeze to me. This has to be a trap right? There's no way Adora would turn against the Horde after everything, and especially no way she'd forgive me.

She sticks her hand out towards me, but I don't take it. "Adora what are you doing?"

"I told you, I'm getting you out of here."

"Why?! You gave up on me, and now suddenly you want to save me?!" She keeps holding her hand out for me to take, staring at me. "Adora, why?..." Still nothing. "Ugh, answer me damn it!"

"I'm not Adora."

"Oh don't try and pull that whole 'That wasn't the real me' bullshit! You made your choices, so live with them!"

She steps closer in front of me and takes me hands. "No, you don't get it. I'm not Adora. My name is Mara, and I'm the She-Ra before Adora."

It feels almost impossible to believe, but somehow I do. The way she grabbed me hands is just... wrong. It's not how Adora would do it. "Mara? Why are you controlling Adora' as body?" A sudden wave of nausea takes over me as I start to think the worst. "Wait, is Adora still in there?!"

"Yes, she is safe. I will relieve control back to her when she's ready. She needs to explore herself a bit and reflect."

"Reflect on what?"

"On you Catra. Your friendship with her is still there. Even after everything the two of you have done to each other, she cares about you. You're the only one who can make her realize she's on the wrong side."

I finally pull my hands away from her. Adora hates me, there's no way she could still care about me. She nearly broke my back the other week! No, my Adora is dead. Whatever twisted version of her is in there isn't her.

"I can see your conflict Catra, and I understand why you're struggling, but I promise you she cares for you. I can see her thoughts when she's in control, and they're often about you!"

I hesitate for a moment, unsure of what to think until I grab her by the arm. "Whether that's true or not, you need to get me and the other rebels out of here."

"Catra we can't get them! It will put us at too much risk!"

"I won't go without them Mara. I can't, they're all I have."

I could feel her arm tense up for a moment before she muttered under her breath. "This is why I like dogs." I dig my claws into her

arm a bit, momentarily forgetting I'm hurting Adora. "Ouch! Fine, we'll get them too!"

I let go of her and start to walk out my cell. It's so strange to be able to walk more than a few feet at a time. The open space feels so nice. I would say ahh fresh air but the air still sucks honestly.

"Where are the cells that the others are in Mara?"

"Close, follow me." She started walking ahead of me and I stared at her as I followed.

Adora, I hope you're okay in there...

Good to Know

'Mara let me out!'

'Adora just give me some more time.'

'No! I want back in my body. You're making me betray the Horde and all my friends!'

'Those people aren't your friends Adora! They've used you as a weapon and the moment you showed any sign of leaving they turned on you.'

'I didn't show any sign of leaving.'

'But it looks like you did. I helped Catra break out the Princesses and now the Horde thinks you're a traitor. You have no choice now, and I'm so sorry for that. I never wanted to have to put you in a situation like this.'

'You're sorry? Well I'll forgive you if you give me back control of my body.'

'Nice try, but no. Not until the rebels are safe and I've moved you far enough away from them.'

She's going to move me away from them? Honestly I'd rather be their prisoner than be alone. I've never liked being alone, and especially after Catra left me I couldn't stand it at all.

Maybe that's why I jumped into things with Ace so quickly... Maybe Lonnie had a point with that part.

Lonnie... That wasn't how I wanted things to go. I think that I was pushing Mara down so hard that whenever I became She-Ra I would lose control. Both of us fighting for control at once? Only makes sense...

'Adora?'

'Yeah?'

'Nothing, you just got quiet is all.'

'Don't take me away once they're safe. I- I can't be alone again...'

'I've been in your head a lot longer than you've been in mine, so I know. I understand what you're thinking but they're going to throw you in jail Adora, you don't want that.'

'Yes I do. You ended things at the Horde for me. Now my options are Horde prisoner, rebel prisoner, or living alone in the wilderness. Seems like an obvious choice to me.'

'I- Okay I guess. Although I'm not sure how being a prisoner is better than picking berries for dinner .' I can literally feel her roll my own eyes at me.

'Hey, don't roll my eyes at me!'

I can feel her laughing, although it doesn't even sound like my laugh. She may have my voice, but she's still herself.

"Hey Mara." Wait... that's Catra.

"Yeah?"

"Is Adora okay?" She's doing that thing wear she rubs her arm all nervous and stuff. Even after everything she somehow still worries about me...

"She's safe if that's what you mean. She's still resistant to what I'm doing though, so I'm going to have to try and help her change."

"Change? Change how?"

She put my hand on Catra's shoulder. "Don't worry about it."

Even though it's my body I still don't want Mara to touch her. 'You better watch yourself. Don't want to get scratched.'

'She won't scratch me.'

'I didn't mean her.'

With me being in her head, I can physically feel her momentary fear. So strange to know exactly what someone's thinking. I guess she's always known what I've been thinking... Weird.

"Hey Catra! You know how close we are yet?" Ugh... Princess Glimmer, or I guess queen now since the old queen was executed. I didn't agree with that choice, but what Hordak says it what we have to do. I do feel bad about it, I mean I'm not a monster like these princesses are.

"We're relatively close, the air smells a lot more like lavender. I still can't stand all the flowers in Brightmoon, the smells mess with my nose."

"Well that never stopped you from letting me put flowers in your hair now did it?" That bitch!

Out of nowhere I can feel Mara hit her before she gets tackled to the ground by Catra.

"Mara, what in the world was that for!?"

"I swear I didn't do that! I did tell you I'm still having to fight Adora for control a bit. Her anger towards Glimmer came on so quick I lost it, I'm sorry!"

So I do have some control... Good to know.

"Well make sure she doesn't hit me again!"

Or what bitch?! You can't hurt me without hurting your precious Mara. She's the She-Ra you all wanted.

"I'm sorry. I thought Adora was starting to be a bit better, but clearly I was wrong."

'Yeah, you were. Except I don't need to be a bit better, I'm already greater than you!'

'Stop it. I really thought you were making some progress! We even had a nice little chat for a bit! Obviously that prom memory wasn't enough. Hope you're ready for round 2.'

'No please don't make me go back in! Mara please don't! Mara-'

What is Your Query?

~flashback~

Man this citadel is huge, and very empty. Even though this place is super colorful and made of pretty crystals, it still has such a bad vibe to it that I can't explain. After walking into the main room I can see a pedestal surrounded by crystals... that must be it.

"Hello?" My voice echoes throughout the entire room. No one is here yet I feel like I'm being watched... "I carry the sword of She-Ra, and I've come here for help. Is anyone there?"

Behind me I can here an electric buzz and I turn to see a hologram that reminds me of Light Hope. "Greetings, administrator. What is your query?" Just as creepy as Light Hope too...

"I need you to teach me how to heal. My friend Scorpia was hurt badly, and I've heard legend that She-Ra is able to heal people."

After a brief pause she just says again, "What is your query?"

This again? Come on. "For the honor of Grayskull!" I look down at my transformed body, annoyed by the white outfit. "Couldn't this come in red? It's a magic outfit, I feel like I should be able to change it."

"Administrator detected. Welcome She-Ra."

"Tell me how to heal my friend!"

"Query not recognized."

"Arrrgh!!! You stupid hologram!" I can't stand this stupid thing!

"Query not recognized." Before I even realize what I doing, I slice down through her with my sword, but it just passes through the

air and slams into the ground. Suddenly everything turns red. "Intruder detected. Activating security protocols." Intruder?

I turn around and look but I don't see anyone, but I do have a certain feeling... "Catra?" In response to my call she steps out from behind a pillar, looking a bit scared because of the robots climbing out of the walls.

She squeaks out a quick, "Hey Adora," before walking over to me. "You can turn these things off right?"

"Are you kidding? I don't even know how to use my sword properly, let alone control an ancient citadel!" The robots surrounded us now, only targeting her. I could just let them get her, it would solve so many of my problems...

But I can't... not to Catra.

I pull my sword up again and start slicing the robots in half one by one, but there doesn't seem to be any end to them. "Come on," I tell her as I scoop her into my arms and jump over the robots to run away down a hall.

"Adora!" She yelps at me as I pick her up. "Okay you can put me down now!" She starts wiggling and kicking at me till I let her go.

"Catra stop it, I'm helping you!"

"You aren't helping me! We wouldn't be in this mess if not for what you did! Scorpia is in a coma because of you!"

"A coma? I knew you guys took her to your hospital, but I didn't think it was that bad... I came her to learn how to heal her."

"Well maybe you shouldn't have detonated those bombs at the princess ball. Who just blows up bombs their partner was carrying without checking to see if they're clear of the blast area yet?! You've become careless since I left!"

The last sentence caught my breath, hurting me every time it echoed back into my ears off the metallic hallway walls. "You left me Catra! You left me, your best friend, for people you had met a few hours before that!"

"They're good people!"

"I'm good people!"

"No you aren't Adora! You just... you just aren't." She looks down at the ground, clearly not wanting to say what she's saying. That still doesn't make it hurt me any less. She takes my hand and says, "You can become good though. There's still a chance to make things right."

"No." I rip my hands away from her and push her back. "Good luck with the robots, I'm getting out of here with or without you. Just don't get in my way." I turned away and started storming down the hall. I walk for what feels like just a few minutes but when I turn around Catra isn't behind me. "Catra?!"

"Adora." Where is she? "Adora! Adora help!"

"Catra? I'm coming, where are you?!" I start sprinting down the hall trying to find her, following the sound of her repeatedly calling out for me. I finally find where her voice is coming from and I open the door and see Catra.

Catra, but as a child.

"Haha! Adora come on and help me!" I look where she's looking and see my younger self.

"Catra I don't want to get in trouble!"

"So you're going to let me get in trouble all by myself?" Ugh. I can see my young self give in. She's always known how to manipulate me, I just never saw it until now.

I'm not falling for her tricks anymore...

"Catra where are you? How are you doing this?!" My voice echoes into the empty room with no reply, our child selves playing. "Quit with these games Catra, it's not funny."

"Adora?" I turn around and see her standing before me.

"Oh, there you are. I thought I lost you." Remember Adora, she betrayed you. You aren't friends anymore... "Not that I'd care if I did lose you, I just didn't want you dying to be on my conscious."

"Adora please just come with me, it doesn't have to be like this."

"What? Be like what?"

"I can't go back there. I can't go back to Shadow Weaver, you know what she does to me!"

No... not this... First us as kids, and now the moment she abandoned me? I march through the fake Catra, angry at whatever is causing this. "I'm not afraid of you! Whoever's doing this show yourself and fight me!"

Still silence like before. With a guttural yell I throw my sword across the room and it gets stuck in the wall on the other side of a doorway. From out of my view a clawed hand finds its way to my sword and Catra's head pops around the corner.

"Jeez. What pissed you off so bad?" She said, not noticing the child versions of us.

Once she noticed and I could see the pain in her eyes, I took my chance. "Do you remember that night? Do you remember what she did to me? What she did because of you?!" I could see the tears swell up in her eyes, and as if on cue Shadow Weaver appeared in the memory in front of us.

"Catra!" Even now it still gives me some chills. "You insolent child, how many times must I punish you before you'll realize your place." It wasn't a question... She just spoke with such a tone that we all knew something bad would happen. The difference is,

Catra and I didn't know what it would be. Shadow Weaver was feeling extra generous on punishments that night...

"Adora, fetch me my whip." Even now those words ring through my ears, pounding like a drum.

"No!" My child self screamed. "It was me that did it, I swear I swear!"

"Oh really? Then are you ready to face her punishment for her?!"

Young me slowly nodded at her, terrified of what came next. She got down on her knees and sat there waiting for the lashes from the whip for what felt like forever. Catra was making such a fuss about it that Shadow Weaver had to restrain her with her magic, muffling her cries for her to stop.

Once the first crack of the whip came and pain scored its way deep into Adora's back, you could hear Catra crying even through the magic gag.

Lash after lash from the whip came, up to a total of five. Young me starts to lower her shirt back down but she's stopped. "Ah ah ah. Double. You got Catra's lashes, and now you get your own for speaking out." She says it so calmly as if this isn't wrong.

Catra's cries got so loud that even through the magic you could make out the word "Stop!" over and over again. Five more lashes, and I had passed out after the first one. She still whipped me four times while unconscious.

I turned to face the real Catra. "Never again. I took ten lashes for you, and the only thing you did was cry. Why were you even crying?! I was the one who got whipped!"

"I didn't ask you to do that! I didn't WANT you to do that! I would've taken a hundred whips if it had meant keeping you safe!"

"Oh really?" I asked her, turning my sword into a whip. "You sure about that?"

I could see her whole body tense up, but then she relaxed and got down on her knees. "If that will fix this, fix us, then yes. I need you back Adora, I miss you."

I miss you too. The words are right there on the tip of my tongue, but I can't say it. I can't be weak. I miss her so much but she's the one who left me, not the other way around. I turned my whip into a bracelet and stuck out my hand to help her up. "I'm not going to whip you." She takes me hand and stands up, then, while smirking, nudges me with her elbow. "This is not because I like you!"

~end flashback~

Desert Rats

I storm through the halls, everyone parting out of my way due to fear. I walk into Scorpia's room and see the arachnid lady sitting on her bed. "Oh hey-" I hit her in the face before she has a chance to open that stupid, annoying mouth of hers.

I pull out my knife and hold it against her throat. "You better help me find her or else I'm going to rip off your entire exoskeleton piece by piece, you understand me?" I hiss at her through my bared teeth, my words filled with the thickness venom.

"Oh wow, okay. That's pretty scary, you almost had me for a second, but the punch was a tad much," she says as she starts laughing. I press the knife harder against her throat, enough to draw the tiniest trickle of blood. "Oh, you're serious. Who do you need me to find?"

"Adora, you idiot! She helped all of the princesses escape and left!"

"Adora did what? That doesn't really sound like her, and I'm pretty sure I know her since she's my best friend."

"Well it happened, so unless you want to be turned inside out, I suggest you start looking." I start walking out of the room and I stop in the doorway, not even looking over my shoulder as I say, "Assemble your team, and make sure you find a replacement for Lonnie's position. I'm filling in for Adora."

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"I can't believe all the princesses ran off into the desert. To think they once controlled Brightmoon and the other kingdoms. This is what they deserve to be though... rats in the desert." I take a big sniff of the air here. It's dry and bland. I can't stand the desert.

"Uh, are you speaking to me or just kind of talking out loud, cause I can't really tell?"
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"Holy shit Scorpia shut up! I don't know how Adora ever put up with you!" The second we get back to Brightmoon I'm going to put in a request to demote her, I don't know how she got her rank in the first place.

"You may not like me Ace, but I am useful. I was the one who called ahead to see if any patrols had seen them try to return to Brightmoon. We'd be searching the forest still if not for me." She has this satisfied look on her face that I just can't stand.

"Well now that you've played your part, stay out of my way. I don't need your clumsiness or stupidity ruining my mission." She stared at me, more hurt looking than angry. Ugh, what a soft bitch. "Kyle!" I can hear fast footsteps approach me from far away. "What did you learn from the people at the bar?"

"I uh, well, not much. No one really seemed to wanna talk to me and I didn't really know what to ask them since you didn't really give me any orders." I turn around to look at him and I can see him standing with his eyes closed, looking as though he's preparing to get hit. Smart guy.

"I gave you your orders. Go find out what they know."

"Wh... what they know about what?"

"Adora you idiot!" This time I do hit him, sending him falling to his ass on the deck of our hover-barge. I grab him by the throat and lift him back up, my claws ever so slightly digging into his neck. "Go back and ask them if they've seen Adora or the princesses. If you don't come back with what I want to know, I'll kill you right here and now in front of everyone."

"Y-you wouldn't do that. You can't!"

"No one likes you Kyle. No one would say a word. Not to Shadow Weaver, not Hordak, no one. Even if they did, they wouldn't care. Now go before I change my mind and kill you now."

As he shambles away from me after I drop him, I can hear him mutter under his breath, "I miss Adora..."

I do too. That's why we're doing this. I'm going to get Adora back, we're going to capture the princesses, and I'm finally going to get to kill Catra...

Thought You'd Stay

drip Nnnh...

drip "Stop..."

drip "Leave me alone."

drip "Oh come on!" I shoot up off of the floor, my forehead slightly wet from the water dripping on me. I look up at the ceiling, another drop about to fall on me. "Don't!" I tell it sternly as I point my finger at it. It actually doesn't fall. "Good boy-" aaand it hit me in the forehead.

Wait... The water distracted me from realizing I'm in my body again? 'Mara?' No response. 'Mara are you in there?' Guess I'm on my own for now. First things first, where am I?

I look around, having moved away from the dripping water and onto a nearby bed, and take in my surroundings. I'm in a cave? Why am I in a cave?

I hear the smallest amount of laughter echoing through the corridors of the cave, making me remember what happened before Mara took over my body. I'm with the princesses, ugh. I look to see if I still have my sword on as a bracelet, but it's gone. "No She-Ra, no problem."

I start making my way through the cave, the conversation and laughter becoming clearer. "I don't understand guys how you could possibly be having fun right now! We just found out Brightmoon is taken over and now we're hiding in a desert cave! Plus, we have the Horde's number one weapon knocked out just down there!" I'm not completely familiar with all of the princesses but I'd know the sparkly one's voice anywhere. Gods she's so annoying.

I start to step out to confront her but I feel something get placed over my mouth and pull me back around the corner. "I wouldn't

go out there if I were you." They let me go and I can finally see who it is.

"Scorpia!" I loudly whisper. "What are you doing here?"

"Well I would say I'm here to rescue you but I'm actually not." That makes me back away a bit and tense up.

"What are you here for then?" I mentally prepare myself to have to fight her. She's my best friend, and I don't want to have to fight her, but if that's what I have to do then so be it...

"I'm here for two reasons. I'm supposed to find you and the princesses and report your location to Ace." Ace is here? They're looking for me? I thought they'd think I turned on them... Maybe there's a chance I can go back to the Horde, maybe explain what happened with Mara. They'd probably lock me up if I told them though... They'll think I'm crazy. "Adora, you okay? Kinda staring at me right now. You have very pretty eyes by the way."

"Oh, uh thanks. Sorry, I was just thinking." She gives me that look. "Fine I'll tell you. I was thinking about you taking me back to the Horde. They won't believe I didn't betray them, and if they do then they'll lock me up for why I did it."

"Wait you didn't betray the Horde?"

I take a step closer to her and hold her claws. "No! I didn't I swear! You have to believe me!"

"Unfortunately, I do believe you Adora..."

Wait what? "Unfortunately?"

"For such a smarty pants you're really stupid sometimes. I'm a double agent for the princesses, have been for a few years."

I drop her claws and back away again, this time with clenched fists. "How could you do that to us? To me?"

"Hey now, I never told them anything about you. I'd only ever worn them you were coming. Adora don't you realize how awful the Horde is? You becoming She-Ra seemed great at first, like we could finally end the war. Every time we made progress though, I could see how much it made the rest of the world hurt. We aren't the good guys here." She picks me up into a big hug. "I hated lying to you, you are a real friend." I reluctantly hug her back... Betrayed aside, I really missed her. "Oh by the way, Ace is on her way here to kill Catra and recapture the princesses."

"WHAT?!?!" I slap my hand over my mouth as if that could somehow retract my scream. Shit... I hear all of the other conversation and laughter stop and footsteps approaching. I want to run to hide, but Scorpia keeps holding me.

"Sorry Blondie, but you and the gang need to have a good chat." She puts me down so I can straighten myself right as Glimmer rounds the corner.

"Oh Scorpia it's you, what's going on? You okay Mara?" Glimmer asks me. She still thinks I'm Mara. Okay, I can work with this.

"Yes princess Glimmer, I am okay." Too stiff sounding? I'm not familiar enough with her voice!

"Oh okay, so you're back," she says with a cold and hostile tone. She teleports behind me and puts me in handcuffs. Damn it, guess I'm not much of an actress. "Someone please lock up the Horde trash."

"Hey!" Scorpia says from behind me, I think jokingly. She makes jokes with them? I guess she really has been on their side...

"Sorry! You know I don't mean you!" Glimmer's attitude went from zero to a hundred and back to zero in less than a minute. She's gonna be such a headache for me...

"Hey guys has anyone seen Catra? Ace is after her so I need to warn her. Also, no one go anywhere above ground, the Horde is searching here everywhere." Seeing Scorpia so casually work with

the enemy hurts me. Maybe she has a point about us being the bad guys... Scorpia is the nicest person I know, so if she's on their side they can't be all bad.

"Shit, I'll go grab her. She's outside right now actually looking around. She's having a tough time with-" she glances at me and mouths the words 'you know who.' "I'll bring her in, but seriously someone lock up She-Ra, or well, the wannabe She-Ra. Can't do anything without your sword now can ya?"

I may not have a sword or free hands, but I always have my head. It's not just for thinking though...

WHAM

Eat that bitch! She looks up at me from the ground, holding her bleeding nose. "You fucking headbutt me?! Rrgh!" She grabs me and teleports me somewhere and then she disappears, leaving me here. It's a makeshift cage with ice bars they set up in another part of the cave.

"Off to a great start Adora. Making them like you is the only chance you have to not be a prisoner forever, and you headbutt the first princess to talk to you," I tell myself out loud.

"I've thought about headbutting some of them too, but I don't want a headache." Outside my cell is the fishy princess, Mermista I think.

"Um, why are you over here?"

"Peace and quiet, or at least it was. Are you going to be chill with us or do we need to keep you locked up? This is a lot less fun for both of us fyi."

"I want to try and be chill, but you people infuriate me."

"Woah, you people? Watch it."

"Hey, I'm technically a princess too!" We both start laughing, although it's short lived.

"You don't seem too bad, besides being a giant angry lady sometimes. See you around hair puff." She seems cool. Maybe I'll have at least one friend here. I can hear her speaking to someone down the hall, but I can't make out what they're saying.

The only thing I can tell is that she's talking to Catra. I don't even hear any footsteps get closer before I see her appear in front of my cell. She looks... sad. I quickly get up and make my way over to the bars. "Why do you look like you've been crying?"

She stares at me with her puffy eyes, her checks stained with tears. "Adora..."

"What?"

Her eyes open wide as she reaches up and grabs her arm, nervously running her finger through her thin fur. "I wasn't sure if it was you or not. Thought maybe Mara was still in control."

"Yeah, it's me. I'm back." Immediately I can tell I shouldn't have said that. She starts to look sad again. I'm back in my body but I'm not back like I'm teaming up with her, not like she wants me to be.

"Did Mara fix you?"

"I wasn't broken Catra. Just because you don't agree with me doesn't mean-"

"This isn't who you are!" Her words echo through my cell, making me here them over and over.

"Yes it is. This is who I am Catra. I'm not a princess, I'm not like the rest of you! I would never betray the Horde!"

"I didn't betray the Horde!" She freezes, choking on her words as she drops to her knees, her body shaking. I reach through the

bars to wrap my arms around what I can reach of her, and she starts whispering. "I didn't betray the Horde. I didn't betray you. I didn't do anything except make a choice to improve my life... Shadow Weaver abused me constantly, and I couldn't take it anymore. I'd rather be without you than to be with her another second. I had to put myself first."

I sat there holding her through the bars, the ice of the bars starting to hurt my skin where it's touching me. I can't let her go though. She left me, but it was for her own good. I shouldn't be mad at her, but even though I want to forgive her I can't do that either. "Catra, why didn't you take me with you?"

I can feel her whole body tense up in my arms. She pulls away from me and stands up to look at me as I stand to match her. The only expression on her face is pure fury. "I TRIED TO ADORA! I TRIED! I TRIED SO MANY TIMES! EVEN AFTER YOU HAD BEATEN MY FRIENDS AND HURT ME COUNTLESS TIMES I TRIED!"

"WELL WHY?!" I shout back. "WHAT MAKES ME SO IMPORTANT THAT YOU WOULD KEEP TRYING TO GET ME BACK?!"

"BECAUSE I LOVE YOU!" We both go completely silent, the look on her own face even more shocked than how I feel. She drops back into a whisper now and says, "I always have. I just thought... maybe for once you'd stay."

"You love me?" Before I can say anything else to her she gets up and runs away. "Catra!" I yell after her, but she's gone. I just sit here in my cell, alone as I start to silently cry. "I love you too," I whisper to myself.

I am such an idiot...

Cheating

What the hell is wrong with me? Why do I have to ruin everything? I finally have a chance to maybe get Adora back, and then I go and fuck it up by telling her I love her. I hadn't even realized I love her... The look on her face when I said it, oh god! Fuck, she's probably so grossed out!

I just keep hurrying my way through the cave, away from her cell. I wanna be as far away from her as I can because I know I won't be able to handle being rejected. I wipe some tears off of my face and bump into something hard and pointy.

"Hey Wildcat!"

"Oh. Hi Scorpia. Didn't mean to bump into you." I look up at her and her smile immediately drops. Does she hate me too? I'm not that bad right?

Suddenly she scoops me up into a big hug. "Catra, why are you crying?" Her asking me that just makes me start crying even harder, my tears dripping off my face and onto her shoulder, but I know she doesn't mind. Scorpia is way too good of a friend for me.

"Adora and I were fighting."

"Well it couldn't have been that bad, Adora can be really nice when she isn't being all 'Horde super-soldier' mode."

"She yelled at me for abandoning her and then I told her I love her."

"I- oh. Wow okie dokie that's a big one." She puts me down, and although I brush my shoulder as if I didn't want to be touched, I miss the comforting feeling. She puts her claws on both of my soldiers and looks me in my mismatching eyes. "Catra, I know you, and I know what you're thinking. Let me just tell you now that you're wrong. She isn't going to hate you. I've seen how

ruthless she can be when fighting, and she always held back when she had to fight you. I mean, she's dating Ace who's basically you but evil. I don't know if she loves you back, but I know she doesn't hate you."

I'm know she probably had some good points, but pretty much everything she just said doesn't matter because I only focused on one part... Adora is dating Ace. I just drop my head and stare at the floor. "I'm such an idiot."

"Come on Wildcat. Come relax for a bit and chill by the fire with the others." We both walk the rest of the way out to the main cavern, Scorpia keeping her arm around me the whole time we walked. I don't deserve her being this good to me.

As we step into the main area we set up, it's completely empty. "Where is everyone?" I ask her.

From behind me I hear an awful voice. "Behind bars like they deserve." Scorpia and I turn around and see Ace in front of us, leaning against a wall trying to be all cool and casual. What an idiot. "Not surprised to see you defecting Scorpia, you always seemed too soft to be part of the Horde. Oh well, I never liked you anyways." I hear Scorpia gasp a little at that, her feelings clearly hurt. "Alrighty now bug bitch, step aside so I can kill this traitor, unless you want me to kill you too that is."

Scorpia's tail shoots towards Ace from behind her back, but they catch it and spring off the wall, driving the spike into Scorpia's neck. She falls to the ground, knocked out from her own poison. "Wow. Thought that would be harder honestly. Oh well." They let out a callous laugh, almost manic. "I've been waiting a long time for this Catra. I'm gonna paint this cave red with your blood," they said with a smile on their face.

They lunge at me and I drop to the floor, sending them flying over me as they miss. I stand back up and shoot them the same smile the shot me. "I don't know if you realize this Ace, but I'm pretty quick too, and definitely a better fighter than you."

"That may be, but you'll never beat me."

"Oh yeah? And why's that?"

"Cause you're too afraid to cheat."

BANG!

I recoil from the loud noise as it echoed through the cave, dropping to my knees as I clutch my ears. After I take a second to recover, I look back up at them also holding their ears. "What was that supposed to do besides hurt both of us?"

"Oh, it hurt you a lot more than it hurt me." I look down and suddenly realize I'm bleeding, a lot. I pull my shirt up and see a hole in my side, just under my ribs.

I start clutching my side to ease the pain and stop the bleeding. I try to stay up but I fall weak and collapse. I look down the hall to where Adora's cell is. "Adora," I try to yell, but it comes out weak and faint. "Adora!" I yell again, louder but strained.

Finally I get out a full scream. "ADORA!" Then everything goes black.

Pathetic

Catra has to be lying. There's no way she could love me, it's a trick. Of course it's a trick, she's a rebel! I should've known this wouldn't work, rrgh. There's no way I could trust her... even if I do love her. It's all a lie...

"ADORA!" My head whips up to look down the hall. Catra's in trouble! So much for not trusting her, I hope I'm making the right choice here...

This is a makeshift cell, and the bars are made of ice from Princess Frosta. She-Ra or not, I can break through ice. HIYA "One kick is all it takes? I thought magic ice would be more durable."

I start rushing down the hall but I see a silhouette in front of me with fluffy hair and pointy ears. "Catra, you're okay!"

"Catra? I get that we're both cats, but that's just insulting. Besides, didn't you see her short hair?" They step forward into the light and I see that it's...

"Ace? What're you doing here?"

"Saving you dummy, and getting the princesses while I'm at it. The rest of the team rounded them up already." They step forward and hug me. "I missed you babe."

I told myself that I love Catra, but she's not the one saving me right boss she isn't the one who had my back after she left. The only thing she ever did was fight me and lock me up. I might love her, but I don't want to anymore. I can't...

I pull away from Ace to look them in the eye. "I missed you too."

"Oh yeah, before we go I have to ask, what's up with you breaking out the princesses? I could tell something was up and at

first I was really mad, but I figured the princesses did something to blackmail you or whatever."

Well actually the leftover spirit of the former She-Ra that resides within me took over my body to control me, set them free, and try to force me through a weird therapy session... "Yeah, blackmail or something... hehe."

"I figured. Ooh hey, I have a surprise for you, come on!" They grab my hand and start running through to corridors of the cave base, dragging me behind them. We step out into the main cavern as they cover me eyes. "Alright you ready?" I nod. "One... two... three!" They take their hand off my eyes so I can see what they did.

And what I see is Catra on the ground, sitting in a massive pool of blood. "Wh- what did you do?..." I whisper.

"I finally got that bitch! Oh I wish you could've been there to see it, it was so exhilarating! To watch the life leave her eyes as she realized I won... Aww and the pathetic way she cried out to you as if you'd help? Nothing will ever beat this day!"

I walk over to Catra and kneel beside her, my legs getting covered in her blood. I pick her up and hold her in my arms and I can tell her body already starting to lose its warmth. I notice on her wrist is a thick gold band. My sword in the form of a bracelet. I slide it off of her wrist and hold it in my hand. I'm so sorry Catra...

"Babe what are you doing? You're getting your clothes all bloody." I feel Ace's hand on my shoulder. I lay my hand over theirs and I stand up, letting Catra go.

They grab my face with both their hands, leaning in to kiss me. "We did it!" they say with a small chuckle as I grab their face the way they're holding mine. "I love you Adora..." I reply in a whisper so quiet I know they can't here me. "What'd you say? Speak up babe."

I look up at them, opening my eyes and letting the tears finally fall from my face. "I said..." I take a few deep breaths, shutting my eyes. "For the honor... of Grayskull." I say, and I feel my body transform into She-Ra. When I open my eyes I have to look down to see Ace, my hands still holding their face.

"Adora... I told you I love you. Say it back, come on."

"No." They look shocked and try to back away from me, but I'm holding their head too tightly for them to move.

"Babe let me go, you're starting to hurt me!" I start to hold their head tighter. "Adora seriously let me go! What the fuck is wrong with you?!" I push my hands even closer together, tightening my grip on their head. I finally let them go, only to grab them by the neck and lift them in the air. Ace starts kicking at my body as I lift them up, but I can barely feel it. "Adora! Adora stop!" they manage to squeak out as I choke them.

"Awwww... the pathetic way you cry out to me, as if I'm going to help..." Their eyes go wide with even more fear than they already had as I mimic their own words back to them. Tears start to fill their terrified eyes as they realize I'm going to kill them.

"Adora please..." they plead through their own crying.

I bring them closer to me, close enough to see how much rage is held in my eyes. "I don't love you Ace. I love Catra, but I bet you always knew that didn't you? Even knew before I did, knew you were nothing more than her replacement, both to me and the Horde. A second rate magicat not worth half of what Catra was. You're fucking pathetic." Just as I'm about to snap their neck, I get hit in the side by an energy blast making me drop them.

"It's She-Ra! I knew she betrayed us!" I look over and see the rest of the team entering the cave, as well as some generic soldiers.

"Kyle, make your team stand down before I have to stop you all myself!" He looks at me, clearly confused and somewhat scared.

"A-Adora, you have betrayed the Horde and thereby are now considered an e-enemy. I have no choice but to take you into custody, and should you refuse I'll..." he gulps nervously. "I'll have to order my team to blast you."

I turn back to look at Ace, but they snuck away while I was distracted. I look at Kyle again. "I'm coming for them Kyle. I only want Ace, I don't want to have to hurt any of you to get to them, you're my friends!"

"No you- you're a traitor!" he yells as he shakily points his blaster at me. I slam my fist against the ground, my bracelet creating a large burst of blinding light. While they can't see I scoop up Catra's body into my arms and escape from the cave. When I'm out I can see the barge that all of the princesses are on.

I leap over and land on it, kicking the driver off as turn my bracelet into a sword so I can blast off the remaining guards. Once they're all off I set down Catra's body and free the princesses. They all look at me, everyone's face covered with sadness and some with a somewhat accusatory anger when they notice the body. "They... they killed Catra... I can't go back now."

Scorpia steps forward and hugs me as I turn back into my normal self, sobbing into her chest. "It's nice to finally have you here Adora... I just wish the circumstances were different..."

"Yeah. Me too."

The Nothingness

That scream... "ADORA!" It just keeps replaying over and over. I can't think about anything else. There is nothing else...

I hope Adora is okay. When I woke up I looked around, but no one is here. "Guys?" I call out, but there's no response from anyone. I walk outside the cave, desperate to find someone, anyone. Instead of walking into the desert though, I walk out into nothing. A completely empty dark void, yet the ground at my feet is wet... No, not wet, it's water! I'm walking on water? "Wh-where am I?!" I shout out into the nothingness.

"What in the world? Catra?! How are you here?!" I turn around and see... She-Ra?

"You're Mara." Okay, I don't know what that means, but it can't be good. "What's happening? How are you here? Where... where is here?"

"Honestly, I don't know. Ever since I died this is where I've been. For the longest time there was nothing here but my memories. I could relive them, but never change them."

"For the longest time?... What changed?"

"Adora did. When she picked up the sword for the first time, she and I established a connection. Suddenly all of her memories popped up around here. I was here waiting for a new one of her memories to pop up so I could see how she's doing, but instead, you showed up... I don't understand."

Just as she said that, the water beneath my feet starts lightly shaking. "What's happening?!"

"Just a new memory popping up. Come check it out with me." She puts her hand out for me to take. I take her hand and I'm shocked at the lack of warmth. She feels... not cold, she just doesn't feel like anything.

"Am... am I dead?" I whisper. She pulls me into a hug, but I can't even feel that. I know it's happening, but only because I see it.

"I'm so sorry Catra. This place is awful. I was really dreading come back here when I gave Adora her body back."

My head still reeling from the fact that I'm dead, I do know one thing now. At least Adora is still alive. "Is this the place you sent her when you took over? It's so dark and.. watery. Why did it have to be water? At least I'm not in it... not that I'd feel it now."

"Dark and watery? For me the sky is grey and the ground is sand. Must be different for each of us... Sorry I don't have more answers for you, I've never had anyone else in here before." I was about to ask her why I'm the first to join her here, but she isn't going to know why... I see her hand reach out again. "Come on, let's go see her latest memory."

After we head over to the memory, the whole world around us started morphing into something else. Suddenly we're on a barge flying through some fields. I see all of my friends, Scorpia too which means she probably got caught betraying the Horde. I also see... "Adora-"

"She won't be able to hear you. All the memories we get are just that, memories. They can't be changed."

I just decided to sit and watch, waiting for something to happen. "What makes the memories show up?"

"It's random. Sometimes I get her eating dinner, other times it's important stuff. It's like reading a book that's missing chapters."

"So this memory could be absolutely nothing?" She just nods at me. Just as I was ready to get up and leave, something caught my eyes. Under a blanket next to Adora is me... She's holding the hand of my body.

I go over to her and sit next to her, leaning my head on her shoulder. She smells just like I remember. Wait... I can smell her?

I can smell her! I reach out and touch her face, my hand suddenly feeling warm. "I can feel her! Mara, Mara come here!"

Mara rushes over to me and puts her hand on top of Adora's head. "I don't feel anything. I haven't been able to since... well, ever really."

Why can I feel you Adora? I sit next to her and lay my head on her shoulder, wrapping my arms around her arm and my tail around her leg. "Catra?" She suddenly stands up and looks around.

"You okay Blondie? Look like you've seen a ghost... Oh, I- Sorry. Poor choice of words."

"I- I'm fine Scorpia... I just thought... nevermind." After that they slowly started turning into water and dripping back down into the water beneath me.

"Is that it? That's the whole memory?"

"Mhm."

"But she felt me! I swear she did! I leaned on her shoulder and she said my name!"

"Look Catra, that can't happen. This happened in the past, it's just a coincidence."

"No, it isn't. It can't be. Bring the memory back up."

"I can't. I can bring up my memories on command, but not Adora's."

Fuck... I want to see her again. I want to be able to feel her again. I want Adora back. She felt me, I know she did. There's got to be a way back. Mara was able to go into her body, maybe I can find a way back somehow too.

I've got to get back to her.

Nicknames

On the way to wherever the hell we're going. I keep holding Catra's hand... it's so cold now but I just can't let her go. Not yet. Even now it's like I can feel her leaning on me. The soft touch of her fur, her warmth, and that comforting feeling she gives me. Actually... I can almost feel her too much. "Catra?" I stand up and look around.

Obviously she isn't here, what's wrong with me? Her body is next to me and I still somehow feel like she's here. I need to accept that she's gone... "You okay Blondie? Look like you've seen a ghost... Oh, I- Sorry. Poor choice of words," Scorpia said, startling me.

"I- I'm fine Scorpia... I just thought... nevermind." She wouldn't understand. She'd think I'm crazy.

"Hey come on now. You know you can tell me. We were good friends in the Horde, and that isn't going to change now that we're both out. We've gotta stick together and look out for one another." She walked up to me and wrapped me up in her big armored arms.

Now, lifted in the air by a Scorpia hug, I finally let myself cry. Not crying, nor sobbing. Just a single lonely tear running down my cheek, betraying my stone-cold facade. "I miss her," I whisper into Scorpia's shoulder. Immediately I feel her grasp on me tighten.

"I know you do. I know..."

After Scorpia put me down I laid down and shut my eyes. It's been a while since I've slept. When I open them back up, the night has completely passed and the sun is just starting to rise. I noticed the hum of the barge engine was no longer present, meaning we've stopped.

I step off the barge, leaving only a sleeping Frosta onboard, and am met with a hard ground. Beneath my feet, as well as all around me, is red stone as far as the eye can see. I see the group sitting next to a large pillar, eating various foods that I will admit look much better than ration bars. I approach them cautiously, however they notice me and all start staring, one by one.

It was Glimmer who spoke first. "So are we just supposed to let her join us? Just like that?" Mermista slaps her arm.

"Uh, yeah! She's fucking She-Ra. If she's willing to join us. We need to take that. Besides, I spoke with her when she was in jail, and she seems kinda cool." Aw, thanks Misty.

"Well I don't trust her... But I will admit she could be useful." Wow, such a nice thing to say Sparkles...

"How do you want me to be useful exactly? I'll help you out if need be, but I'm not your thrall," I tell her. She may be a princess, or I guess a queen now, but I'm not taking orders from her.

"Ughhhhh!" She gets up and grabs me by the hand, dragging me over to the other side of the pillar. "See those runes? This is a First Ones place. Can you open it or not?"

Reading the runes, they say, 'The Vault of Marlena.' Whoever that is, they must have something worth protecting down there. I stick out my hand and place it on the runes. They start to glow and then the door slides up and out of the way. Revealing a downwards tunnel with a ladder in it.

I lean around the pillar and say to the rest of the group, "Anyone wanna go down a spooky, mysterious First Ones hole?" To my surprise, Mermista immediately stood up.

"I love mysterious shit!"

"All right Misty, lead the way." She makes her way over to me and pats me on the shoulder.

"Hold off on nicknames for now. You aren't there yet with us so it'll come off as patronizing." Noted...

After Mermista makes her way down, Glimmer gestures for me to get in. "No way I'm going in before you She-Ra. You'll probably close the door on me and trap me."

"I didn't think of that, but now that you mention it, it's kind of a great plan." She doesn't look amused. "Fine, I'll go in first. Jeez." With that I head down into the vault behind Mermista, Glimmer immediately following me down.

The concerning part?... the door automatically closed after Glimmer came in and I can't get it back open...

Your Fault

I can't believe I'm stuck in a First Ones temple with She-Ra. What a disappointment she was to all of us. We thought the legendary hero had shown up, only to find out she was loyal to the Horde and wants to destroy everything good in this world. At least I have Mermista to keep me company.

"Honestly, considering you were evil for such a long time, you're cooler than I thought you'd be."

"Well considering you're a princess, I'm surprised you're cool at all."

They both laugh and in unison go, "Aaah, princesses..." sarcastically. Maybe Mermista isn't the company I was hoping for down here. She's getting along with She-Ra too well. I mean, it's her fault that Catra is dead! The Horde came for her, not us! And everyone is acting like it doesn't even matter! They were sad for a night and now it's back to business as usual...

We need to mourn her... I need to...

"Hey, Glim, you okay?" I wipe away the slight trace of a tear next to my eye.

"I'm fine Misty. Let's just look around and find a way out of here. I don't wanna be stuck with her any longer than I need to be." As we walk further and further into the vault, more and more of it starts lighting up. It keeps branching off into so many different paths, every time breaking off into three more. But alas, She-Ra somehow knows the way! She has these 'instincts' about it. Well I have my instincts too, and they say not to trust her.

"Guys, over here. I found something." She says as she runs her hand over the wall.

"That's just a wall, what could you have possibly fou-" She pushes a button on the wall and it slowly dissolves a section of the wall,

revealing it was a hologram. Figures she's right...

"This place feels dangerous, we need to be careful. Not you though Glimmer, you should be toootally fine. Why don't you go on ahead of us?" I can hear the smile on her face. What a bitch.

"Why don't you go first? You seem to somehow know this place. It's likely a trap you've led us into anyways." We both keep staring at each other, our brows furrowed. I don't get why she hates me so much, I'm not the villain here.

She-Ra starts looking angry at me. Oh fuck, was I thinking out loud? "You seriously don't think you've done anything wrong? You might be on the right side, but that doesn't mean you haven't done bad things. You're the one who took Catra away from me! I never wanted to be what I am, but without her... without her there was no one left to help me stay on the right path. All these horrible things I've done are my burden, but I hope you know that in some way, they're your fault too. I mean come on, it's your fault your mother died!"

She immediately looked shocked at what she said as I recoiled away from her. "Glimmer, I'm sorry. I shouldn't have brought that up."

"Yeah, you shouldn't have. There are a lot of things you shouldn't have done, like picking up that sword. It is my fault my mother died, you're right, but it's your fault Catra died. The Horde came looking for you, and it was the person you were dating who killed her." My words are weirdly calm despite how furious I am. My hatred for her has never burned hotter than it is in this moment. "Once we get out of here, I am going to kill you She-Ra. Know that, and know that I mean it."

"Are you two done? I found a cool glowing relic." She tosses the relic to She-Ra. "What's it do?"

"Honestly, I have no idea. There's a crazy amount of energy coming off this thing, but I can't seem to activate it... This has

never happened before."

"Oh great, you're broken!" Of course the moment she joins us she becomes useless! Every boss character sucks once they're on your team, basic video game logic. She-Ra starts walking away with the relic, but I won't let her steal... whatever that is! "Stop walking away. I said stop!"

She raises her arm high in the air, and smashes the relic on the ground, though instead of shattering into pieces it turns into a small pile of sand. She bends down and grabs something out of it. At first it looks like a handle, but the more she pulls, the more a long blade gets revealed. She takes the sword off of her back and drops it on the ground, holding the new sword in her hand. "For the Honor of Grayskull," she says as the whole room glows, the light dimming and revealing She-Ra.

"You have a second sword?! Are you fucking kidding me?!"

Goodbye Catra

"Where are they Mara?"

"I don't know. Definitely First One's though. This place doesn't feel familiar at all."

I'm walking around the area of the memory, ignoring Glimmer and Adora's fight that's going on. I walk around, bored, tracing my claw along the wall until it slides against a small nub. It looks like a button, so naturally I push it. What I didn't expect was a door to slide open right next to Mermista. "Mara I think I did something!"

"For the last time Catra, you can't do anything. We can't touch the outside world. These are just memories."

"But I pushed a button!"

"Anything could've opened that door Catra. The button didn't even move when you touched it." Suddenly her attention is completely taken away from me. "Woah." I turn my head to see what she's looking at, and it's... me?

There, standing in front us us, is me in a She-Ra outfit. "What the hell is going on?" The She-Ra me looks at me, and she walks over to me.

"Catra," She-Ra me says to me. "It's so good to finally see you. Incredible, you look just like me, ah but you do have your father's eyes." I back away from myself, or, well... my mom? "Don't be scared sweetheart. I know you don't know me, you were never given the chance, but I know you. My spirit has been residing in you."

"M-mom?" She opens her arms to hug me and I practically tackle her with a big hug. "Are you dead too?" I ask her.

"Too? What makes you think you're dead my love?"

"Um, well I got shot and bled out, and now I'm stuck in some sort of abyss."

"You got shot? That's all? I would've thought a daughter of mine could survive such a minor inconvenience," Mom says with a sly smirk on her face. Oh yeah, she's definitely my mom. Her attention gets pulled over my shoulder. "Oh you must be Mara! Razz has told me so much about you! Mara seems to tear up a little at the mention of Razz.

"You know Razz? Is she okay?!"

"Calm down dear. She's fine, however she'd got her timelines all jumbled so she gets confused a lot. Keeps mistaking Adora for, and you for Adora in your time!" She starts laughing, and it sounds exactly like mine. This is absolutely crazy.

"Mom?" She turns to me again and takes me by my hands. "Why do you look like She-Ra?"

"Because I am She-Ra silly. Well, not She-Ra, but similar. The war you're fighting started before you. Your father and I were a part of it. We had the idea of condensing our runestone down to a smaller size, the same way they did to make the Sword of Power." She looks over my shoulder, her expression turning sad. "This is where we must part ways my love. Unfortunately I don't think I'll be seeing you again, but know that my spirit resides in you always. Goodbye Catra, I love you."

"I love you too Mom," I tell her as I hear a crash behind me, causing my mom to fade away into an orange essence. I turn to face the crash and I see Adora pull a sword out of a pile of sand. I walk over to her and I put my hand around her. She looks slightly startled and looks straight ahead, into my eyes. "Adora, I'm here." I squeeze me hand around hers, and she takes on the slightest smile.

"For the Honor of Grayskull." When she says the words, my mom's essence swirls around us and goes into the sword.

"Bye Mom." Just as Adora turns into She-Ra using my mom's sword, the memory fades away.

I can't believe what just happened. I met my mom, she's another She-Ra, and my family has a runestone?! My family... I might have a family out there. Wait... I'm dead. My mom said I wasn't dead though. How could I not be dead? Ugh, how come the afterlife has to be confusing and frustrating too???

My Hope Died

"Well this is... different," I say looking at the strange armor on me. It's almost... catlike.

"Adora, why is there a second Sword of Power?! And why does the armor look like that?!"

"Awww Sparkles, you called me by my actual name! You must be warming up to me." I don't think sassing her is the best way to handle the current situation, but it's just so fun.

"Just answer the question, and stop with all the sarcasm!"

"Well, the sword is a different sword, so it makes sense that the armor is different." I poked the top of the headpiece where it's ears are. "It looks like it's for a cat person, like... like Catra."

Misty suddenly perked up when I said that. "Adora, you just gave me an idea. None of us have ever seen any other cat people besides Catra. Maybe this sword has the rune from the fallen kingdom! Maybe!... Let's go!" Mermista starts rushing her way towards the exit, which is still shut. The second sword starts to glow and the exit magically opens up. When we all come out, the whole group was waiting around the entrance.

"Glimmer!" Bow yelled as he pulled her into a big hug, actually even lifting her off the ground. "I'm so glad you're okay!" Haha! Voice crack.

"Bowww put me down!" He puts her down and immediately Glimmer goes to find Mermista, who had immediately shoved her way through the crowd and and stomped off.

"Where are they going?"

"I don't know Bow, but I think I have a guess." I start following Glimmer and Mermista, everyone else following with me. We all end up on the barge we took here. When we get there, I see

Mermista, standing over Catra's body, with the sword in her hand. "Mermista, what are you doing?"

"Hold on Adora! I got this." She bends down, almost looking like she's going to stab Catra, but instead she lays the sword on her chest and wraps Catra's hand around the handle.

Nothing happens. We sit there for about ten silent minutes, everyone in the group slowly trickling away until it's just Mermista and I. I walk over to her and kneel at her side, wrapping her in an awkward hug. Don't judge me, I'm not used to be nice!

Mermista starts crying in my arms, leaning heavily into me. "Why didn't it work?!" she sobs out. "It should've worked! I was so sure!" She starts sobbing even harder, to much to speak anymore. I didn't know what to do, so I just sat there and let her cry on me.

Sometimes that's all anyone needs.

Her crying finally eases and she looks up at me with her puffy red eyes. They're suddenly filled with another spark of hope. "The words! I didn't say the words!" She quickly moves out of my hug and puts her hands back on the sword. "For the honor of Grayskull. For the honor of Grayskull. Come on! For the honor of Grayskull!"

Still nothing happened.

The silence after her shouting was deafening. I moved slightly to hug her again, but she shot up and ran away. I never thought Mermista of all the princesses would get like that. She and Catra must've been closer than I realized.

I looked over at Catra's body. Her cheeks have started to sink in, her body is breaking down already. She needs to be buried soon... My eyes started to tear up, but I needed to vent, so I speak out with a broken voice. "Hey Catra... I really miss you... I wish you were still here. I'm sorry I couldn't save you... I'm so so sorry. You said you wanted me to stay, well here I am. I'm staying. I don't feel like I fit in here at all, but I'm trying my best. I'm trying for

you. You're my best friend. You're- you're more than that. You're everything to me. I love you Catra." With my final words, the gem on her sword starts to glow.

I gasp and fall back away from her. I keep looking at her, waiting for something else to happen, anything else. The runestone stopped glowing, and my hope died with its glow. Just as I thought it was nothing, I saw it. Just the tiniest little bit of movement. Her flaccid fingers wrapping around the handle a little tighter. "Catra?..."

Her eyes slowly open and look over at me. She weakly reaches out a hand that I desperately take. In the softest whisper I've ever heard her voice make, she utters her signature, "Hey Adora..."

The Somethingness

Thankfully the nothingness isn’t actually empty. Lately it's been constantly filled with laughter and the wet slap of Mara and I's feet running around the empty wet landscape. It feels so great to have another person here. Even better, a friend. I may be dead, or sort of dead, but honestly it's not too bad.

All of a sudden I feel that familiar rumble, signaling that a new memory popped up. I go over to it and I see Mermista running, but Mara grabs me arm and pulls me to face her.

"Catra, where are you going?"

"I'm checking out the new memory from Adora." She looks puzzled.

"What new memory?"

"The one right here!" I turn around and point at Mermista, who is kneeling down in the distance. "Don't you see Misty?"

"I don't see anything. I'll let you go check it out I guess." I nod at her and walk over.

Mermista is on the ground crying, with Adora hugging her, although Adora looks awkward. How long has it been since she's hugged someone?... That's when I see it. My body, again. I have my mom's sword laying on my chest, my hand wrapped around it. I barely even pay attention to that though, and I stare more at myself.

My cheeks are sunken in, a little bit of fur has fallen off of me, and my exposed skin is blue and lifeless. My mom said I'm not dead, but I definitely seem dead. I don't understand.

"For the honor of Grayskull. For the honor of Grayskull. For the honor of Grayskull!" Mermista says over and over. I don't understand what she's trying to do, unless...

Is she trying to bring me back?

There's no way.

Except, suddenly I feel different. I feel lighter. I feel... warmer? I look down at my hands and what I see shocks me, freezing my in place. I'm see through, as if I were made of mist. I'm turn around and see Mara already running over to me.

"Catra!" She reaches me as I fall on the ground. I don't feel weak, I just feel heavy. Mara kneels beside me and I reach out my hand. She eagerly takes it, tears starting to well up in her eyes.

"Hey Catra." Her voice is shaky, her eyes filled with tears. "I think you're gonna get to go back now. I'm so happy for you but... but I'll definitely miss you. You know, when you first came here, I told you I didn't feel anything, but that's not true. I feel happy getting to hang out with you, and I'm both excited and devastated you're leaving." We both give weak little chuckles through our crying. Just then, Adora starts talking to me too, the dead body of me.

"Hey Catra... I really miss you... I wish you were still here. I'm sorry I couldn't save you... I'm so so sorry. You said you wanted me to stay, well here I am. I'm staying. I don't feel like I fit in here at all, but I'm trying my best. I'm trying for you. You're my best friend. You're- you're more than that. You're everything to me. I love you Catra."

When she finished, I started fading away even faster. "Bye Catra. Tell Adora 'Hey,' for me."

I nod at her as I disappear fully. "Bye Mara."

I blink, and suddenly the color has come back to the sky, and instead of Mara holding my hand, it's the love of my life. "Hey Adora."

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